Walt

Europe reclaims tap-to-pay

The Problem

Tap-to-pay in Europe lives with Google and Apple

200–250M

Europeans use Apple Pay or Google Wallet for in-store purchases[1]

€700B+

in mobile wallet payments at European point-of-sale terminals (2024)[2]

<0.4% combined market share for everyone else.[3] No legitimate tap-to-pay alternative exists for either iPhone or Android.

Apple Pay

- Charges European banks ~0.05% per transaction [4]
- Extracts €300–500M annually from European transactions [5]

Google Wallet

- Harvests every transaction for ad profiles and selling to 3rd parties [6]
- Estimated €1B+ annually in ad value from European payment data [7] [8]

The only alternative is to go back to physical cards or cash. For Europeans who care about privacy, there is no tap-to-pay option at all.

Solution

A European, privacy-first alternative to Apple Pay and Google Wallet

Privacy by design

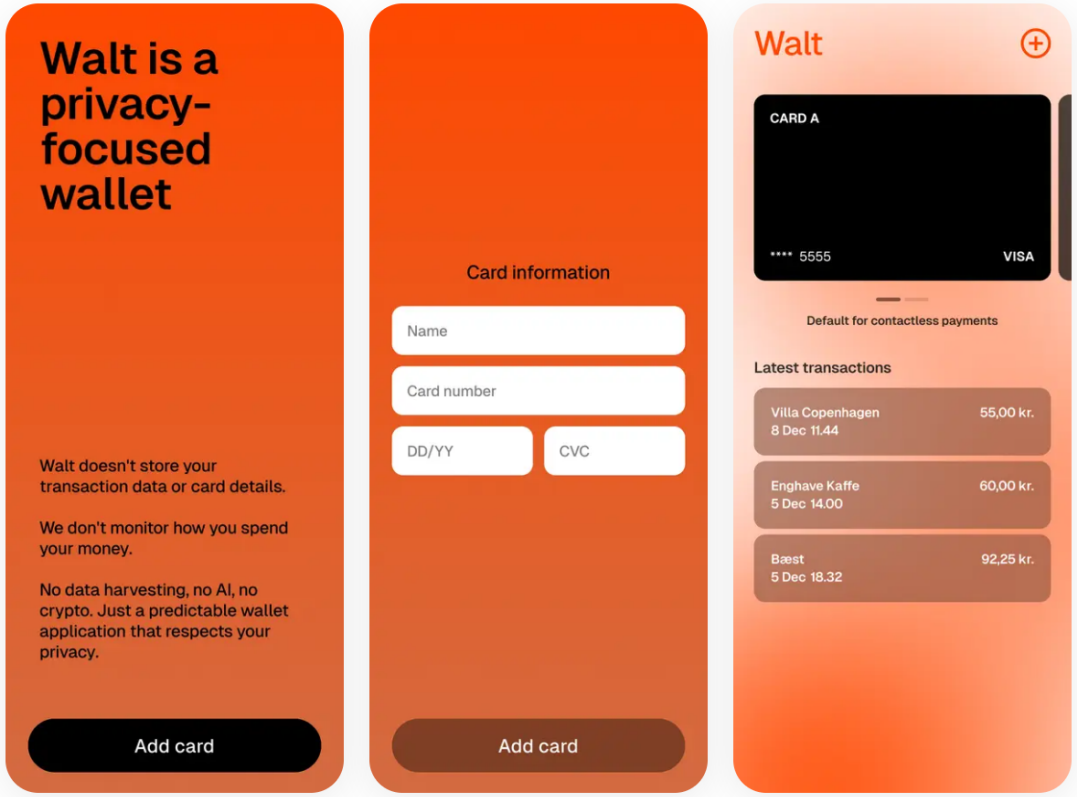
- Transaction data stays on the device. No centralized database, no server-side logs
- No ad profiling, no data harvesting, no third-party sharing

Built for Europe

- Founded in Copenhagen to establish European sovereignty
- No dependency on US cloud providers for core infrastructure

Simplicity

- Entire app is tap-to-pay. One workflow, nothing else
- One pricing model, no tiers, no extra features to upsell



Download | Add card | Tap to pay

Why Now?

EU regulation opens tap-to-pay to third-party wallets

2014–2024

iPhone NFC locked

Apple restricts iPhone NFC exclusively to Apple Pay. No third-party wallet can offer tap-to-pay on iPhone for a decade[9]

2024

EUDI wallet mandate

EU regulation mandates privacy-by-design digital wallets across all 27 member states[10]

DEC 2024

First alternative launches

Vipps MobilePay goes live as the first Apple Pay alternative on iPhone. 200K cards activated in 24 hours[11]

JAN 2025

First NFC transaction

First third-party contactless payment completed on iPhone via the new NFC APIs[12]

MAR 2025

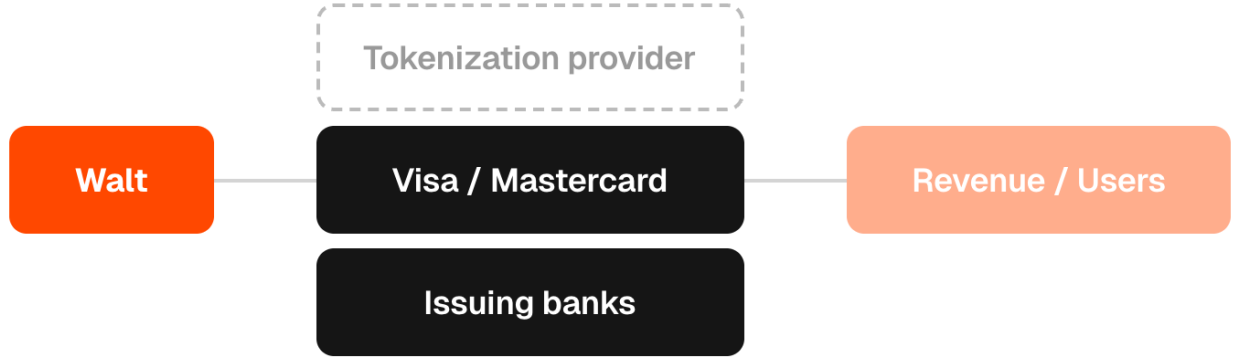
Walt

The first entirely private tap-to-pay wallet enters the market

For the first time, a completely private tap-to-pay wallet is possible on every smartphone in Europe.

Challenges

The infrastructure for third-party phone wallets is still being built



To enable tap-to-pay, Walt needs a **tokenization provider**: a company certified by Visa and Mastercard that converts card numbers into secure payment tokens, connecting a wallet to the banking system. The EU opened iPhone NFC to third parties in 2024, but no provider yet offers a production-ready SDK for independent phone wallets.

IDEMIA

FULL SDK, ENTERPRISE ONLY

World's largest independent token service provider. Launched Tap & Pay SDKs for both iOS and Android.

Will not engage with early-stage startups.

Fidesmo

860+ BANKS, NO PHONE SDK

Certified Token Requestor for Visa and Mastercard with pre-approved issuers across Europe, including key Nordic banks.

Wearables only.

Paymentology

HCE SDK, NOT PRODUCTION-READY

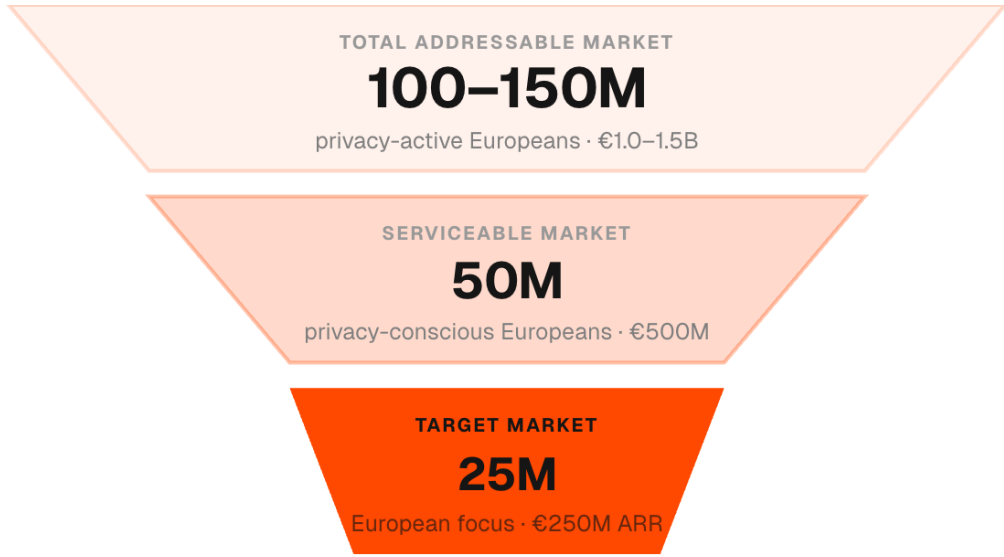
Global card issuing processor. Subsidiary MeaWallet provides an HCE SDK and tokenization infrastructure.

Phone wallet SDK not yet production-ready for third-party tap-to-pay.

The Market

Privacy is a proven, paying market

MARKET SIZING AT €10/YEAR



PROVEN DEMAND

3 privacy companies have crossed $100M in annual revenue[14]

COMPANY	SCALE	REVENUE
Proton	100M+ accounts	~$97.5M
Brave	101M MAU	$100M+
DuckDuckGo	100M daily searches	$100M+
Signal	70M+ MAU	~$25.8M

Competitors

Competitors offering tap-to-pay as a secondary feature

	Walt	Wero	Vipps
NFC tap-to-pay is core product	✓	—	—
NFC tap-to-pay live today	—	—	✓ Limited
Private, no data collection	✓	—	—
User base	**0**	50M	12.5M
Revenue model	**€10/yr subscription**	Merchant pays fee	Merchant pays fee
Geographic focus	**Europe**	DE, FR, BE	Nordics

Traction & Roadmap

Pre-launch with core infrastructure in place

CURRENT STATUS

3k signups

Pre-launch · 3+ months from first transaction

MILESTONES

- ✓ Android and iPhone apps built
- ✓ End-to-end PCI compliance
- ✓ Organic customer validation (r/BuyFromEU)
- ○ Tokenization provider partnership
- ○ First cards loaded
- ○ First tap-to-pay transaction

GO-TO-MARKET

PHASE 1 **Privacy communities**

Target: Early adopters & beta

Organic word-of-mouth in privacy-focused communities. Early adopters sign up for the beta program.

PHASE 2 **Organic European growth**

Target: Niche communities

Expand across Europe through organic discovery in communities like Reddit, Mastodon, and privacy forums.

PHASE 3 **High-visibility channels**

Target: Scaled distribution

Targeted reach across privacy-aligned platforms: Proton, Brave, DuckDuckGo, and similar channels.

TARGET MARKET	SERVICEABLE MARKET	TOTAL ADDRESSABLE
25M	50M	100–150M
€250M ARR	€500M	€1.0–1.5B

The Ask

Expand the investor network for a Q3/Q4 2026 funding round

TIMELINE

Q3/Q4 2026

Funding round to take Walt from beta to scaled distribution

WHAT WE NEED

Introductions to investors aligned with **privacy**, **open platforms**, and **European digital sovereignty**.

USE OF RESOURCES

TOKEN REQUESTOR

Tokenization provider

Pay the certified Token Requestor to activate Visa and Mastercard tokenization. The missing link to enable live tap-to-pay.

DISTRIBUTION

Proton & Brave advertising

Targeted campaigns on privacy-aligned platforms where Walt's core audience already lives. Reaching 200M+ privacy-conscious users.

Walt

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References

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11. Vipps MobilePay press release (December 9, 2024); Thales and Vipps, “NFC Payments on iOS reaching one million users” (May 2025)
12. Vipps MobilePay first contactless NFC transaction via Apple HCE APIs (January 2025)
13. Proton, Tuta, Brave, and Mullvad adoption data; Walt European “Privacy-Active” market sizing research (2025)